INTERVIEW
CEO

A TALE OF TWO CITIES

The iconic 130-year-old, Parisian luxury store, Galeries Lafayette, finally dropped anchor in Mumbai, in partnership with Aditya Birla Fashion Retail Limited (ABFRL). Spice caught up with Nicolas Houze, Executive Chairman of Galeries Lafayette Group, and Sathyajit R, CEO International Brands, ABFRL to explore the future of luxury in India.

Shilpi Madan

Galeries Lafayette has officially brought its "stunning fashion roulette" to India. Known for blending architectural splendour with luxury expertise, the Parisian powerhouse is pivoting toward the Indian market to bridge the fashion gap between the two cultures. What started as a small haberdashery in 1893 has evolved into a global landmark—and its newest home is Mumbai's heritage-rich Kala Ghoda. Housed in the twin colonial edifices of Turner Morrison and Voltas House, the 90,000-square-foot space is a curated mix of global brands and artistic expression. Against the backdrop of the Indo-French Year of Innovation, the store's arrival strives to meet the rising demand of a domestic audience that is more fashion-forward than ever.

Excerpts from a conversation with Nicolas Houze, Chairman of the Board, Galeries Lafayette

Q: Galeries Lafayette Mumbai hosted the commencement of the Year of Innovation, for India and France. What makes this a pivotal move?
Galeries Lafayette Mumbai is our flagship store in India and to host the French Presidential delegation here carries a powerful meaning. It reminds us that retail is never just about transactions. It is about relationships, trust, and shared ambition. It is also about carrying a piece of France beyond our borders, and allowing the very best of French joie de vivre, creativity, elegance, and innovation to resonate across shores. We have created a bridge between French and Indian heritage, and Mumbai, with its incredible energy, entrepreneurial spirit, and cultural diversity, is the perfect home for this new chapter.



